

# Baseline

*Know your margins before March.*

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## The Problem

Mid-scale corn and soybean farmers across the US Midwest face a structural disadvantage at the negotiating table. Every year, they must commit to expensive input purchases — seed, fertilizer, chemicals, and labor — months before harvest, with no independent reference point for what those inputs should actually cost. The vendors selling inputs and the agronomists recommending them both carry conflicts of interest, leaving farmers without unbiased data when it matters most. The result: overspending that quietly erodes margins season after season.

## The Solution

Baseline is a farm financial planning SaaS tool that gives farmers the benchmark data they've been missing. Using anonymized, regionally aggregated peer data, Baseline lets farmers compare their per-field costs and margins against similar operations in their area — before they sign purchase agreements. The platform includes a real-time financial scenario engine for modeling what-if changes to input costs, a decision logging system for tracking commitments and validating them against actual outcomes, and a reporting layer designed to be shared with lenders and advisors.

## Target Market & Go-to-Market

Baseline targets mid-scale Midwest corn and soybean farmers, with early traction focused on Missouri agricultural cooperatives and university extension services as distribution partners. The go-to-market motion is bottom-up: individual farmer adoption generates the anonymized data pool that makes the platform more valuable over time, which then enables upsell opportunities selling data access and analytics to cooperatives and agricultural lenders. The early customer acquisition target is 40+ farmers, with co-op and extension partnerships accelerating reach.

## Why Now & Key Differentiator

The agricultural inputs market has grown increasingly opaque as consolidation among seed and chemical companies has reduced competition and transparency. Baseline's core differentiator is independence: unlike tools offered by input vendors or co-ops, Baseline has no financial relationship with the suppliers whose prices it benchmarks. That neutrality — combined with real, localized peer data rather than national averages — is the trust anchor the product is built on.